CFO CRAFT

Crafting Success Stories Together

CFO CRAFT

Senior finance leadership for services firms.

Strategic and Fractional CFO Services



CORPORATE PROFILE

2026

As a business grows, its finance function often stays where it started.

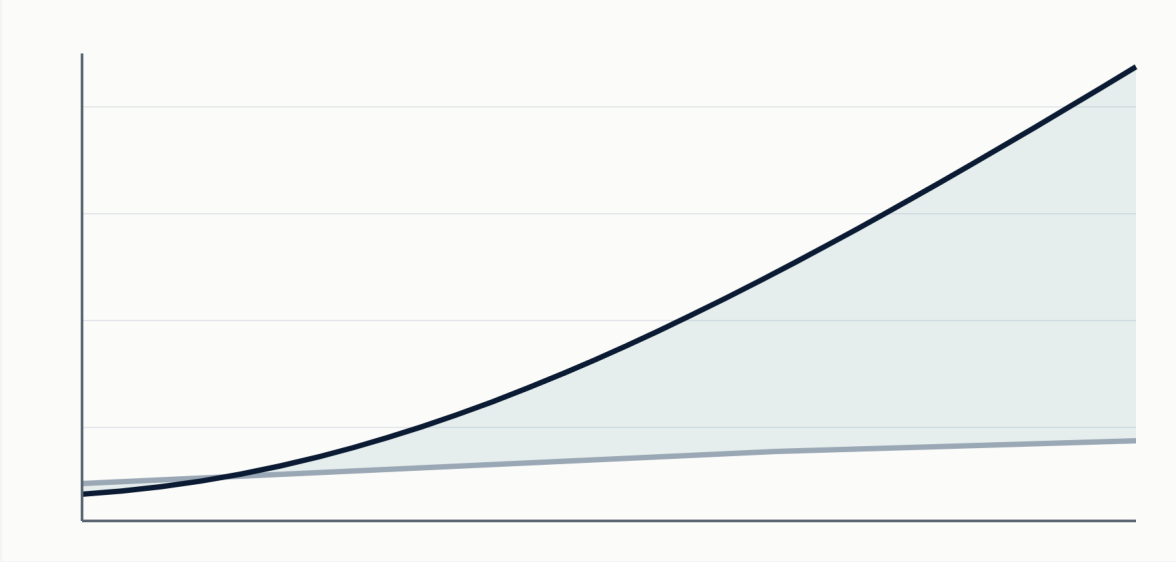


Chart is illustrative

Profitable on paper, short of cash

Growth absorbs working capital faster than profits replace it.

Pricing without knowing true cost

Quotes and fees rest on estimates, not the true cost to deliver.

Numbers that arrive too late to act on

Month-end reports describe what happened, not what to do next.

Lender conversations that are reactive

Funding is negotiated under pressure rather than planned ahead.

Senior finance leadership, engaged at the depth your business needs.

What we are

- A finance partner to the promoter and the management team
- Accountable for the quality of financial decisions, not only the books
- Focused on cash, margins, planning and funding
- Working alongside your accounts team, auditors and bankers

What we are not

- An outsourced bookkeeping or accounting service
- A substitute for your statutory auditor
- A filing service for tax and GST returns
- A one-time report that is filed and forgotten

Four industries, each with its own economics.

01

Manufacturing

Knowing what each product really earns.

Product and job costing	Plant and line P&L
Capex evaluation	RM, WIP and FG cycle

02

Trading and distribution

Thin margins, where every day of credit counts.

SKU and customer margins	Credit control
Inventory turns	Bank limit headroom

03

Services firms

Whether a busy firm is actually profitable.

Billable utilisation	Project profitability
Owner draws vs. profit	Billing and collections

04

High-growth startups

Numbers that hold up in front of investors.

Runway and burn	Investor MIS
Unit economics	Diligence readiness

03 · HOW WE THINK

One line of reasoning in every engagement.

01
Business issue
What the promoter is actually concerned about.

→

02
Financial insight
What the numbers show, and what is driving them.

→

03
Management decision
A specific choice, with an owner and a timeline.

→

04
Business outcome
The result, tracked against a baseline.

ILLUSTRATIVE EXAMPLE · A SERVICES FIRM

Headcount and revenue have grown, but profit per person has stayed flat.

→

Utilisation is below target in two teams; fixed-fee projects are running over their estimates.

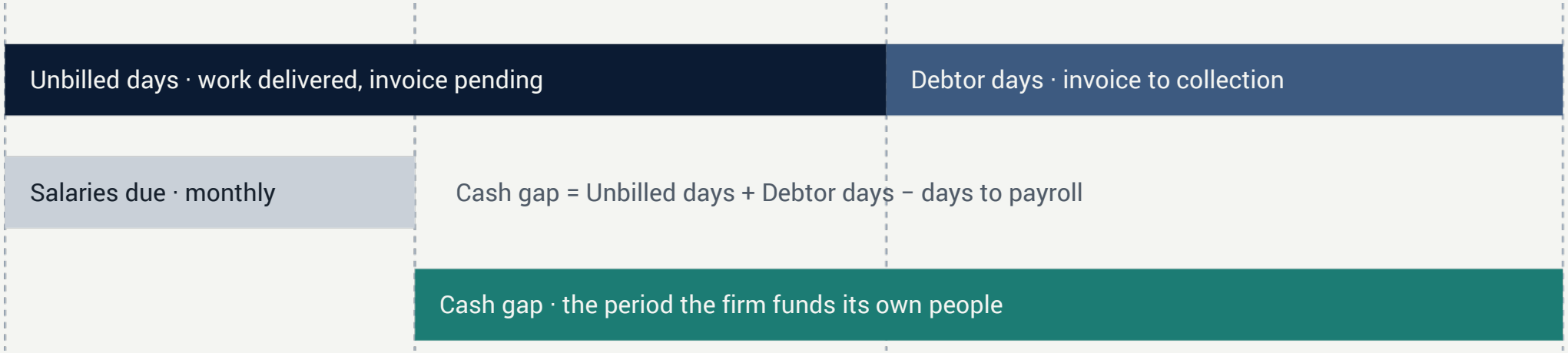
→

Reprice fixed-fee work on actual effort; set utilisation targets by team.

→

Project margin and utilisation reviewed every month.

In a people business, salaries are paid long before clients pay.



Billing

Milestones, invoicing timelines and unbilled work tracked monthly.

Collections

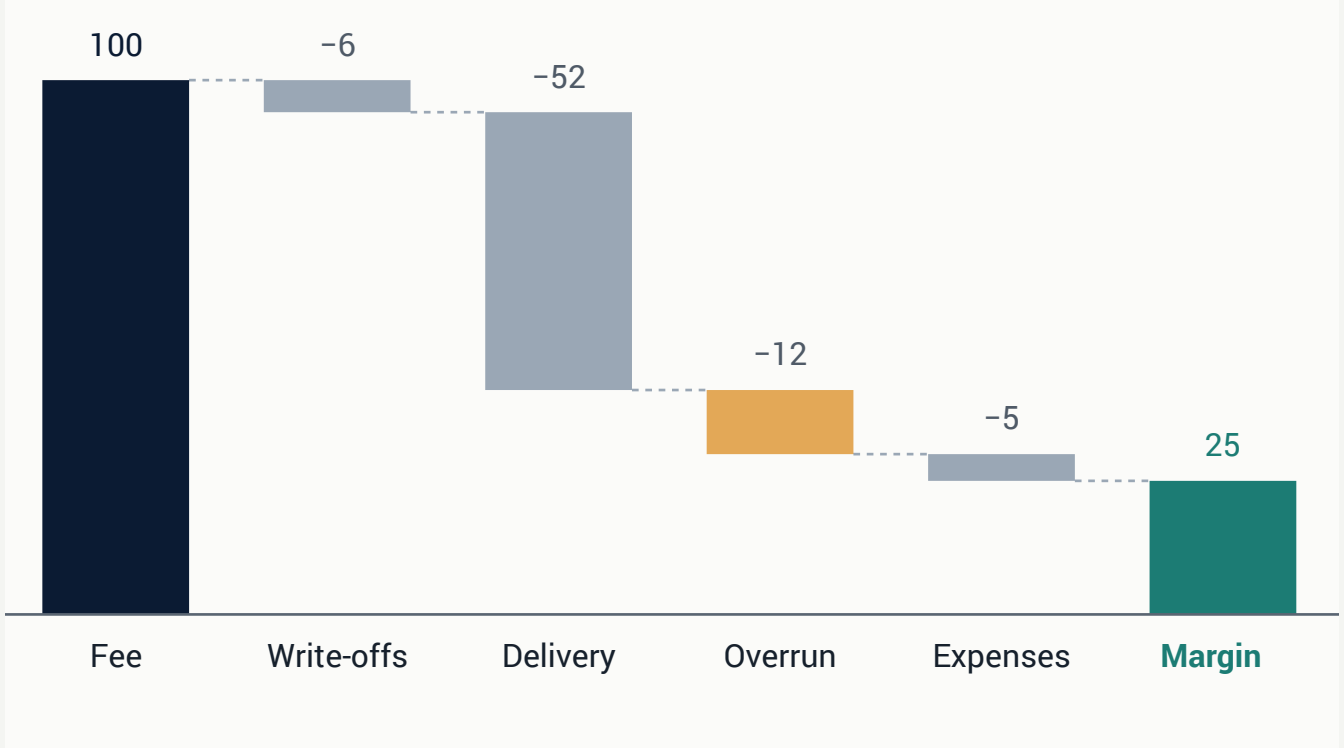
Debtor ageing, and client TDS matched to your tax credit statement.

Owner draws

A draw policy tied to distributable profit and cash reserves.

Illustrative, not to scale · Salaries are the first call on cash

A busy firm can still lose money on its fixed-fee work.



Illustrative, indexed to contracted fee = 100

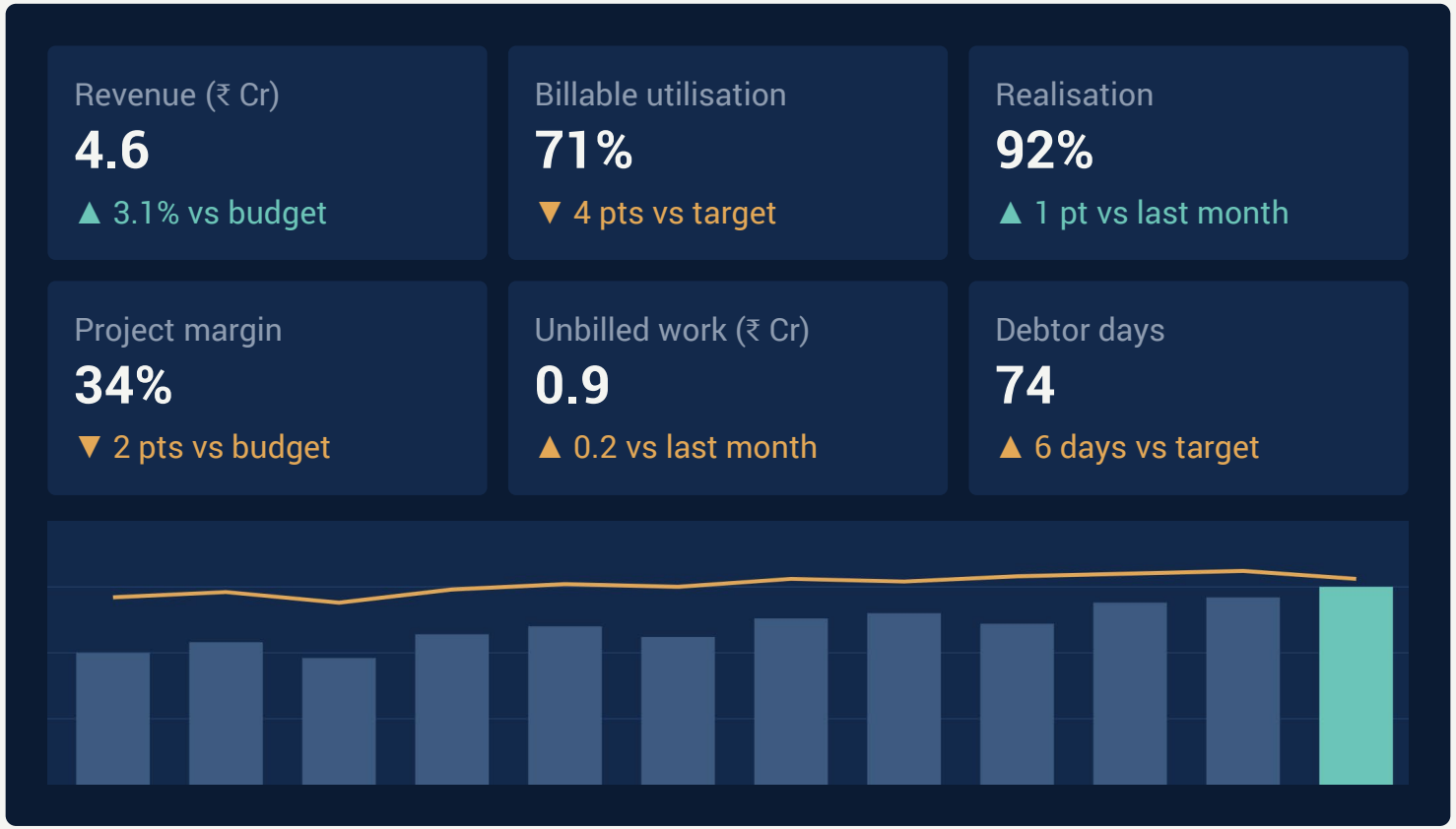
Costed on actual hours at a loaded rate, each project shows what it really earned against the fee and the estimate.

Margin by project and client

Early warning on fixed-fee overruns

Rate card reviewed against actual effort

An MIS pack built around where the hours go.



Sample layout with illustrative figures

Inside the monthly pack

- Utilisation by person, team and practice
- Realisation against standard rates
- Margin by project and client
- Unbilled work, debtor days and 13-week cash
- Owner draws against distributable profit

Start where you are; move up as you grow.

START HERE

Finance Diagnostic

Fixed-fee health check of books, cash, margins and compliance.

One-time

FRACTIONAL CFO

Starter

Your numbers every month, and a CFO to explain them.

Monthly, priced to scope

FRACTIONAL CFO

Core

A CFO who owns your monthly finance rhythm.

Monthly, priced to scope

FRACTIONAL CFO

Growth

Forward-looking finance for bigger decisions.

Monthly, priced to scope

Specialist and project work	Cash, compliance, fundraising, ERP and M&A, scoped as defined projects, alone or alongside any tier.	**Custom, by proposal**

From reporting, to ownership, to planning.

What is included	Starter	Core	Growth
Monthly P&L, balance sheet, cash flow and KPI dashboard	✓	✓	✓
Time with a CFO each month	30-min call	Review meeting	Review meeting
MIS with written commentary	–	✓	✓
Margins by project and client	–	✓	✓
Cash oversight and collections priorities	–	✓	✓
Compliance oversight: GST, TDS and ROC calendar	–	✓	✓
Close and reporting standards for your accounts team	–	✓	✓
Annual budget, rolling forecast, budget vs. actuals	–	–	✓
Decision support: capex, pricing, new lines, hiring	–	–	✓
Banker and auditor coordination	–	–	✓

Your accountant keeps the books; your CA firm keeps statutory audit and return filing

Senior depth on demand, for defined problems.

PRACTICE AREA	WHEN YOU WOULD CALL US	TYPICAL SCOPE
Cash flow and working capital	Cash is tight despite reported profit; bank limits fully drawn	13-week cash forecast and a working-capital release plan
Compliance and controls	Reconciliation backlogs; controls behind the pace of growth	GST, TDS and ROC health review; control design and finance SOPs
Fundraising and banking	A term loan for capex, limit enhancement or an equity raise	Projections, CMA data, lender pack, Pitch Deck and query management
ERP and finance transformation	Moving to, or struggling with, an ERP; growth has outpaced systems	Requirements, vendor evaluation, reporting design, migration oversight
M&A and integration	Buying, selling or merging a business; promoter restructuring	Financial due diligence, transaction model, post-deal integration

Audit, attest work and statutory valuations are done by independent registered professionals

Most engagements begin with the Finance Diagnostic.

Books and reporting

Can the numbers be relied on, and how fast do they arrive?

Cash and working capital

Where cash is tied up, and what is driving the squeeze.

Margins and profitability

Which projects, clients and service lines make money.

Compliance and controls

How close you are to a notice, a penalty or a surprise.

WHAT YOU RECEIVE

- Written diagnostic report
- Red, amber, green scorecard by area
- Prioritised action plan with owners
- Findings readout with your team
- Data format for a monthly retainer

01 · Diagnose

Fixed-fee review; findings before any retainer.

02 · Design

MIS format, calendar and controls set up.

03 · Run

Close review, MIS and cash forecast on a fixed date.

04 · Advise

Monthly review on pricing, hiring, capex and funding.

Senior finance judgment on every engagement.



FOUNDER

Sudhir Gawandi

Chartered Accountant · 25+ years in finance leadership

A career on the finance side of manufacturing, trading, professional services and technology businesses, across large corporates, mid-market companies and SMEs. Founded CFO CRAFT in 2022 and works directly with the promoters and managing directors it serves.

Sectors	Areas of depth	Based in
Manufacturing, trading, services, technology	FP&A, MIS, working capital, ERP, M&A integration	Mumbai

A named CFO owns your account

One senior person is accountable for your numbers and attends your monthly review.

Senior review on every output

MIS, forecasts and recommendations are reviewed by the engagement CFO before they reach you or your bank.

Your data stays confidential

Access-controlled systems and a written confidentiality agreement on every engagement.

The team working alongside the founder.



Mukesh Gupta

Director – Assurance

Chartered Accountant · 30+ years

Former senior roles at Big Four audit firms. IFRS, US GAAP, Ind AS, internal controls and complex audits, including listed companies.



Asmita Vagal

Principal Consultant

Chartered Accountant · 25+ years

Financial management, accounting and reporting across Canada, India and Asia-Pacific. Controls and process implementation.



Vikas Mimani

Principal Consultant

Chartered Accountant · Registered Valuer · 20+ years

Certified Independent Director. Acquisitions and integration, IFRS and Ind AS, COSO framework and business valuations.



Satyanarayan Patro

Principal Consultant

M.Com, MBA (Corporate Finance) · 23+ years

Planning, budgeting, costing, cash flow and project finance; ERP and MIS. Previously with Motherson Sumi, JBM Auto and Sanden Vikas.

CFO CRAFT

Crafting Success Stories Together

CFO CRAFT

Start with a conversation about your numbers.

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